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CART 315 Digital Game Prototype

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Reflection for Chapter 2

Chapter 2 of Pippin's book *The Stuff Games Are Made Of* changed the way I think about rules in games. Through the chapter, Pippin brings up different variations of Pong and how even though people claim that the rules of the game are fixed and unchangeable, but when you think deeper, you can change parts of the game to not keep it stagnant. For example, he made a reiteration of pong called Blind Pong and basically the barriers and paddle hit box are removed so the chance of winning is by luck. This invokes different emotions in players when playing a game where using the paddle is pointless cause it will just phase through it.

What resonates with me the most is the idea that rules are not necessarily fixed or untouchable. Growing up, I got told that with rules of the game and being told what to do and not to do and there's nothing to change or argue against. But, he put it in a different view that it is a creative material. For example, Trace Pong, it mixes playing ping pong but it adds an element of play and art by engaging the players to continue to play it and make art and when the ball goes into the goal, the lines erase and you start anew.

The chapter made me think about how asking "what if?" can be an important part in the creativity process. Changing one rule reveals possibilities that would otherwise stay hidden. This is something that is applicable outside of games and can help us solve problems in a different perspective.